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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

DUBAI MIRACLE GARDEN OFFERS FREE ENTRY

■ UAE residents made the most of free entry to the Dubai Miracle Garden yesterday, in an initiative aimed at offering families and visitors in the city a chance to unwind. Until March 31, all residents can enter the garden for free by presenting a valid Emirates ID at the entrance. The garden will be open daily from 9am to 9pm during this period.

UAE shows restraint despite 1,909 attacks

GARGASH SAYS COUNTRY HAS RIGHT TO DEFEND ITSELF

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dr Anwar Gargash, diplomatic adviser to the UAE President, stressed that the country has the right to defend itself against the imposed terrorist aggression, while continuing to exercise restraint and prioritise stability and diplomatic solutions.

In a statement posted on X, Gargash said Iran's claims that the UAE had acted aggressively came after as many as 1,909 Iranian attacks on the country. He added that the Iranian position reflects a confused policy that had misread the situation.

Gargash said the UAE retains the right to defend itself against the imposed terrorist aggression, while continuing to prioritise stability and rational dialogue.

He reaffirmed that the UAE is committed to diplomacy and continues to support efforts aimed at reducing tensions, including attempts to provide a diplomatic off-ramp for both Iran and the wider region.

Scale of Iran's aggression

Gargash said Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi's remarks instead reinforced Iran's isolation and highlighted the scale of its aggression, despite the UAE's sincere efforts to mediate between Washington and Tehran until the last moment in an attempt to prevent the conflict.

Gargash also stressed that Iran's attempts to target Gulf countries in response to American and Israeli strikes reflect the military weakness, moral bankruptcy and growing political isolation.

In another post on X, Gargash said such actions demonstrate Tehran's inability to directly confront its adversaries, adding that "mislead-

EMIRATES FLYERS CAN REBOOK WITHIN 72 HRS

Emirates is offering travellers greater flexibility amid changing flight schedules. Passengers can now rebook flights online within 72 hours of their original departure, helping reduce disruptions and avoid unnecessary trips to the airport.

Bookings can be managed through the Emirates website at Manage Your Booking or via the Emirates mobile app, allowing passengers to select new dates and manage their travel plans from anywhere. For passengers who wish to reschedule flights earlier than 72 hours before departure, Emirates has advised contacting their support team directly. Assistance is available online at Emirates Support or via direct message at DM link.

The airline emphasised that these measures are intended to ensure passengers can adjust their travel plans conveniently, while continuing to provide up-to-date guidance and support during evolving regional conditions. Following the partial reopening of regional airspace, Emirates is operating a limited number of flights. Passengers are advised to check the latest schedules and book seats in advance. The airline emphasises that the safety and security of passengers and crew remain the highest priority.

Passengers are urged not to share booking details, contact information, or personal data in public replies. Fraudsters may misuse this information. Emirates encourages sending a Direct Message (DM) for private assistance.

— Lekshmy Pavithran, Assistant Online Editor
SEE ALSO P-11

ing media statements will not conceal this reality".

He added that a "return to reason" requires Iran to stop targeting neighbouring countries and instead engage constructively with regional mediation efforts.

Meanwhile, the UAE's air defence systems intercepted four ballistic missiles and six drones launched from Iran yesterday, the Ministry of Defence said. Since the start of the Iranian attacks, UAE air defences have dealt with 298 ballistic missiles, 15 cruise missiles and 1,606 drones, according to the ministry.

Six deaths, 142 injuries

The ministry said the attacks had resulted in six deaths among UAE, Pakistani, Nepali and Bangladeshi nationals, as well as 142 minor to moderate injuries among individuals of various nationalities, including

Emirati, Egyptian, Sudanese, Ethiopian, Filipino, Pakistani, Iranian, Indian, Bangladeshi, Sri Lankan, Azerbaijani, Yemeni, Ugandan, Eritrean, Lebanese, Afghan, Bahraini, Comorian, Turkish, Iraqi, Nepali, Nigerian, Omani, Jordanian, Palestinian, Ghanaian, Indonesian and Swedish nationals.

The Ministry of Defence said it is fully prepared to deal with any threats and will firmly confront any attempts to undermine the country's security, stressing its commitment to safeguarding the UAE's sovereignty, stability and national interests.

The UAE has also continued efforts to ensure the safety and wellbeing of all those who live in the country, with authorities working to facilitate the return of around 500 Golden Visa holders and residents who had been stranded abroad.

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Trump rejects deal to end war with Iran

US urges allies to escort tankers through Hormuz

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said Washington is not ready to seek a deal to end the war with Iran, signalling that the United States and Israel will continue their offensive until what he called "better terms" are achieved.

Speaking to NBC News, Trump said Tehran appeared eager for negotiations but insisted the current conditions were unacceptable. "Iran wants to make a deal, and I don't want to make it because the terms aren't good enough yet," he said, adding that US forces would intensify attacks along Iran's northern coast near the Strait of Hormuz to secure shipping lanes. Trump also suggested the United States could bomb Kharg Island, Iran's main oil export hub, again after American warplanes struck military installations there on Friday, remarking that Washington might do so "just for fun".

Fresh attacks

The comments came as Iran launched fresh missile and drone attacks on Gulf countries and Israel, while US and Israeli warplanes carried out new waves of strikes inside Iran.

The conflict has plunged the Middle East into turmoil, disrupted global air travel and pushed up energy prices worldwide after threats to shipping effectively halted traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, a waterway that normally carries about a fifth of the world's oil and gas.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said the war would

Trump also suggested the United States could bomb Kharg Island, Iran's main oil export hub, again, remarking that Washington might do so 'just for fun'.

only end once Tehran was certain it would not be restarted and reparations were paid.

"This war will end when we are certain it will not be repeated and that reparations will be paid," Araghchi told Arabic-language outlet *Al-Araby Al-Jadeed*.

Cautious response

Trump has urged countries including China, France, Japan, South Korea and the United Kingdom to deploy naval vessels to escort oil tankers through the strait while US forces target Iranian missile, drone and boat launch sites. However, the proposal has received a cautious response. Britain said it was discussing options with allies, while Japan indicated the legal threshold for deploying naval forces would be extremely high. South Korea said it was closely monitoring the situation. Iran warned other countries against joining the conflict, with Araghchi urging them to refrain from steps that could escalate the war further.

Elsewhere in the region, Saudi Arabia and Bahrain reported intercepting renewed barrages of projectiles, while Bahrain announced the arrest of five men accused of spying for Iran's Revolutionary Guard and providing coordinates of key sites.

Israel, meanwhile, approved an \$827 million emergency military budget to address urgent wartime needs, according to Israeli media reports.

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IFTAR 18:31

Fajr	05:10	Shuruq	06:24
Dhuhr	12:30	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:31	Isha	19:45

IMSAK 05:00

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



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